

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, October 14, 2020, in the Council Chambers of City Hall and via Zoom.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:34 p.m.

Mayor Lovett read the following statement: *This meeting is being conducted in accordance with the provisions of the Governor's Executive Order no. 2020-04 and the emergency meeting provisions of RSA 91-A to permit participation of board members by electronic means. Under the conditions of the current COVID-19 pandemic and the protocols established by the Centers for Disease Control (CDC), it is not reasonably practical for a quorum of this board's members to attend this meeting in person.*

To join the webinar:

By Telephone:

Dial: 1 646 558 8656

Webinar ID: 882 3823 3399

Passcode: 376500

If there is a problem getting through to that number, please call 603-542-7002.

Members of the Council present, including location and who is in the room:

At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier – home, son

At-Large Councilor Erica Sweetser – Council Chambers, Councilor Stone and public

Assistant Mayor Allen Damren – home, alone

Mayor Charlene Lovett – home, alone

At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau – home, alone

At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski – work, alone

Ward II Councilor James Contois – home, alone

Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone – Council Chambers, Councilors Sweetser and public

Absent:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne

Also present:

Edward Morris, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett said item 10 D. Application for Community Revitalization Tax Relief Program (RSA 79-E) 31 Myrtle Street is for discussion. A resolution will be presented to the Council at the next meeting.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Stone to accept the minutes of the September 9, 2020, City Council meeting.

Mayor Lovett asked that the motion to accept the August 22, 2020, Council minutes indicate that that was a walking tour of the City center.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Councilor Kier and seconded by Councilor Matteau to accept the minutes of the September 23, 2020, City Council meeting.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett – abstain (not at meeting)

Motion carried 7-0, 1 abstain.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Matteau to accept the minutes of the September 30, 2020, City Council meeting.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

MAYOR'S NOTES

- Thanked John Paul and his wife for cleaning up the flower beds in Opera House Square.
- Drive-through flu vaccine clinics Saturday, October 17, at Valley Regional Hospital; and Sunday, October 18, at Claremont Middle School; free. For information, go to greatersullivanstrong.org.
- November 11th is Veterans Day. Reminder to check the condition of flags. American Legion will hold an event at Broad Street Park at 11 a.m.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

- **Police** - Saturday October 24, 2020, Claremont Police will be available at two community events.

First, is a **DRIVE UP & DROP OFF** drug take back event, 10 a.m. until 2 p.m. in the parking lot in front of CVS, located at 1 Wall Street.

Second, Claremont Police has also partnered with the Claremont Soup Kitchen to host a Food Drive in the parking lot of Hobby Lobby on Washington Street on October 24, 2020, from 10 a.m. until 4 p.m. This is also a **DRIVE UP & DROP OFF** location. Cash or check donations for the Claremont Soup Kitchen will also be collected by staff.

- **Fire Department** – Thanked the Claremont Savings Bank Foundation for its \$850.00 donation to the Fire Department to help with the Smoke Detector program run by the Claremont Fire Department.
- **Airport** – The Airport Apron Project is about complete and is now open and usable. The City is also in the final phases of completing the Terminal Building Project.
- **GOFERR** – The City has recently received its third, and final payment, from the State's GOFERR Fund that was used to distribute CARES Act money to cities and towns. The reimbursements we have received are as follows:

Reimbursement Request #1 - \$26,666.70

Reimbursement Request #2- \$54,910.25

Reimbursement Request #3- \$232,061.05

These three reimbursements equal the \$313,638.00 that was allotted to the City of Claremont. He thanked the staff for tracking their expenses throughout this pandemic, and a special thank you to Amanda Benoit, the City's Office Assistant, for taking on the task of collecting the information and completing all the grant paperwork.

- **139/147 Main Street** – Contracts for the shoring and demolition work are expected to be signed by October 12th, and then work can begin. Pine Hill Construction is the contractor.
- **Drought Update** – He thanked all who have helped conserve water through the voluntary water conservation measures released by the City last month. The recent rain has helped a little to offset the water usage the last week. We hope the rain predicted in the long-term forecast helps the City's reservoirs to start to refill. We still ask that the residents and businesses of Claremont try to conserve water as much as possible by:
 - Preventing water waste, runoff, and by not running water on impervious surfaces
 - Refrain from washing down outside areas such as sidewalks and patios
 - Water plants the minimum amount required
 - Wash only full loads in clothes washers and dishwashers
 - Use spring-loaded nozzles on garden hoses to reduce unneeded flow
 - Identify and repair all water leaks
 - Limit vehicle and boat washing to the minimum
 - Use showers rather than baths
 - Refrain from leaving faucets running while shaving, brushing teeth, or while rinsing dishes
 - Install water-flow restrictive devices in showerheads
 - Install water-saving devices such as plastic bottles or commercial units in toilet tanks to reduce volume

The rain we have had is still not enough, so please continue to voluntarily conserve water.

- **Halloween** – Hallowesta has been cancelled, however there will be a drive-through event on October 31st, in Monadnock Park. Trick or Treating guidance has been put out to help do so safely. He cautioned against wearing a COVID mask under a Halloween mask, as you may have trouble breathing.
- Farwell Block Dental Office is now open.

Congestion Mitigation Quality Assurance Grant for Charlestown Road public meeting will be held at the Claremont Savings Bank tomorrow, 6 p.m.

- **COVID-19 Update** – As of the time this report was written, the State of New Hampshire has continued to have an uptick in positive COVID-19 test results mostly due to the recent acceptance of the rapid COVID-19 test results, that were not reported as positive cases in the past without a follow-up test also coming back positive. Even with this uptick, NH remains at a relatively low rate of infection, and according to the DHHS website we currently have 4 active cases in all of Sullivan County, and 0 active cases in the City of Claremont.

- As of now, there are 6 cases in Sullivan County and 0 in Claremont.

As we enter cold and flu season, it is more important than ever, to stay vigilant in our efforts to control the spread of the virus, or any sickness. If we continue to keep good hand hygiene and sanitization efforts, maintain social distancing, and wear masks when in public, we can continue to keep our numbers low and protect the health of the citizens of Claremont, not only against COVID-19, but also against the common cold and flu.

He reminded people to review the symptoms of COVID-19 and if you start to feel multiple symptoms, to get tested to help control the spread of the virus. Valley Regional Hospital is now an NHHHS testing site. For pre-registration or to make an appointment, please visit <https://www.vrh.org/covid-19-information/>. For questions, please call the COVID Hotline at 603-542-7850.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Claremont Planning Board

A motion was made by Councilor Kier and seconded by Councilor Matteau to appoint Matt Mooshian to seat 8 of the Claremont Planning Board.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Stone to re-appoint Cindi Cleveland to seat 2 of the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

Historic District Commission

A motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Assistant Mayor Damren to appoint Erin Angley-Cohen to seat 1 of the Historic District Commission.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Rita Quintey, Ward 2, presented the Council with a petition asking Councilors to continue the Christmas holiday custom of displaying the Christmas lights and Nativity Scene in Broad Street Park. She said that display has been in Broad Street Park for 50+ years.

Shirley Baldasaro, Ward 1, said she is in favor of having the holiday display in Broad Street Park. She hopes it stays the same.

Rebecca MacKenzie, Ward 2, said this week there has been a request/question at the Planning and Development Department for a hearing for a C&D transfer station on Industrial Boulevard. She asked people to go to the Facebook page of A Better Claremont to sign a petition to oppose the C&D facility.

OLD BUSINESS

NH Retirement System Presentation

George Lagos, Executive Director, and Marty Karlon, Director of Communications & Legislative Affairs, NH Retirement System, showed a PowerPoint presentation, Overview: FY 22-23 Employer Contribution Rates. They discussed how the Employer Rates are developed; Actuarial Experience Study; showed the FY 2022-23 Employer Rates; Primary drivers on rates are reduction of the assumed rate of investment return from 7.25% to 6.75%, adoption of updated post-retirement mortality assumptions, and reduction in the payroll growth factor; Unfunded liability of \$4 billion; Key Takeaways: revising the assumptions was necessary to properly fund the plan over the long term, the Board is bound by legal and Constitutional requirements with

respect to determining contribution rates, and these changes do not change the cost of the plan, only the time of the payments.

Mr. Karlon said there are three streams of revenue: member contribution, employer contribution, and investment income. The employer contribution is the relief valve. Investment income has accounted for more than half in the fund.

Mr. Karlon said during this legislative session they are expecting to see more titles after the November election, and one is for the state to pick up a percentage of the contribution. Prior to 2011, the state was paying 35%, for Police, Fire, and Teachers. That is one to watch.

Formation of Community Power Aggregation Committee

Mayor Lovett gave a brief history. According to the RSA, Council must approve formation of the Committee if it chooses to move forward with possibly developing an Aggregation Plan.

Mr. Morris said at the September 23rd meeting, Councilors talked about formation of the Committee. The Energy Advisory Committee (EAC) had discussed this and had talked about having one Council Representative, two EAC members, and a few regular members. One discussion they had was that if they did not get any regular members, that some EAC members may be able to fill those seats. The recommendation is for this committee to be formed by the Council and to be appointed by the Council, and to be a sub-committee, working with the Energy Advisory Committee, making recommendations to them that would then come to the Council.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Sweetser that consistent with RSA 53-E:6 and the recommendation from the Claremont Energy Advisory Committee, the Claremont City Council authorizes the creation of an Electric Aggregation Committee that will work as a subcommittee of the Energy Advisory Committee. The purpose of the Electric Aggregation Committee will be to study community electric aggregation, make recommendations for or against the City's participation in such a program, and, if agreed upon, to develop a municipal aggregation plan in accordance with RSA 53-E:6. The Electric Aggregation Committee shall be composed of five (5) members appointed by the City Council, consisting of one (1) Council Representative, two (2) Energy Advisory Committee members, with terms expiring on alternating years, and two (2) regular members, with terms expiring on alternating years, and two (2) Energy Advisory Committee members that can serve as alternate members for any vacant regular member seat, with terms expiring on alternating years. Members will be Claremont residents. The Electric Aggregation Committee will report to the Energy Advisory Committee who will make recommendations to the City Council. This committee will exist until its purpose is fulfilled.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 8-0.

Ordinance 576 Amend Merit Plan – Third Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposed change is to create a position which is titled, the Adverse Childhood Experience Response Team (ACERT) Coordinator. This will be a new position within the City of Claremont's Police Department, however, no grade or salary ranges will be impacted by this amendment as this position will be slotted into the City's existing Grade 8 of the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule – Attachment C [which document is on file at the City Manager's office]. The current maximum salary for a Grade 8 employee is \$56,829 and the minimum salary is \$37,362.60.

The amendment seeks to create this position in support of the Greater Claremont Area ACERT Program. The responsibilities of this employee will largely be associated with identifying and offering assistance to those families and children who are exposed to violence or other adverse conditions. The creation and development of this position as well as the financial obligations associated with this hiring are to be shared by and through a partnership that the City maintains with the Newport Police Department, Turning Points Network, the Sullivan County Child Advocacy Center, the Claremont School District and the TLC Family Resource Center.

Enactment of this Ordinance will amend the City of Claremont Merit Plan accordingly and institute a full job description for the position of Adverse Childhood Experiences Response Team Coordinator. This change is requested by the City Manager.

Police Chief Mark Chase said this is the third reading. It is part of the Victims of Crimes Act Grant.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Assistant Mayor Damren to adopt Ordinance 576 Amend Merit Plan.

Councilor Contois read the ordinance into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote:
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes

Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 8-0.

Ordinance 577 Property Tax Credit for Veterans – Second Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposed change is to increase the benefit provided to veterans or their surviving spouses who qualify for said tax credit. If adopted, the credit shall increase from an annual tax credit of \$125 to the new standard set at \$500. In addition, the date for the submission of an amended permanent application shall be set for December 1 of every calendar year.

This amendment is intended to recognize and appreciate the dedication as well as sacrifice of our nation's veterans.

Enactment of this Ordinance will amend the City of Claremont's Code as to Article II, Division 2 of Chapter 18 (Sec. 18-43). This change is requested by the City Manager.

Mayor Lovett clarified that this was voted on by the Council in 2019 and this is housekeeping in order to update the City Code.

Stephan Hamilton, Interim Assessor, said this is housekeeping to make sure the Code reflects action taken by the Council.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Matteau to adopt Ordinance 577 Property Tax Credit for Veterans.

Assistant Mayor Damren read the ordinance into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Mayor Lovett recused herself as she is a veteran.

Roll call vote:
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - recused
Motion carried 7-0, with 1 recusal.

Ordinance 578 Property Tax Exemptions for Elderly – Second Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposed change is to increase the qualification income(s) and asset holdings for those individuals seeking an elderly exemption from real estate taxes from the City of Claremont.

The motivation behind this amendment is to simply account for inflation and maintain a more current set of qualifications for potential applicants. The last change to these qualifications occurred in 2017 and the City's Assessor is of the belief that an update to same is warranted at this time.

Enactment of this Ordinance will amend the City of Claremont's Code as to Article II, Division 4 of Chapter 18 (Sec. 18-58). This change is requested by the City Manager.

Mayor Lovett said this is updating an action that was taken in 2019.

Mr. Hamilton said this ordinance is housekeeping to make sure Code matches the action taken by the Council.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Kier to adopt Ordinance 578 Property Tax Exemptions for Elderly

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

NEW BUSINESS

Ordinance 579 Disabled Exemption – First Reading

The purpose of the first proposed change is to increase the qualification income(s) and asset holdings for those individuals seeking an exemption for a disabled person from real estate taxes from the City of Claremont.

The motivation behind this amendment is to simply account for inflation and maintain a more current set of qualifications for potential applicants.

The amendment also seeks to eliminate social security benefits from the exclusion of income in determining eligibility. This proposal is merely an attempt to correct the original language which conflicted with RSA 72:37-b III in that such income from social security must be considered in calculating net annual income.

The only other proposed change is to move the exemption application deadline from March 1 to April 15.

Enactment of this Ordinance will amend the City of Claremont's Code as to Article II, Division 3 of Chapter 18. These changes are requested by the City Manager.

Mayor Lovett asked if this is housekeeping. Mr. Hamilton said yes. He noted it had an erroneous date. Mayor Lovett asked that the explanation reflect that it is housekeeping.

Councilor Contois read the Explanation of Proposed Action.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Koloski to suspend Council Rules to not read the entire ordinance.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

Mayor Lovett noted this is not a proposed change; this is housekeeping for an action that was voted on in October 2019.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Kier to adopt Ordinance 579 Disabled Exemption.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes
Motion carried 8-0.

Ordinance 580 Board of Assessors Membership – First Reading

The purpose of this proposed change is to prohibit a member of the Board of Assessors from serving concurrently on certain specified City boards and commissions.

Enactment of this Ordinance will revise Chapter 2, Administration, Article II, Section 2-126 by limiting members of the Board of Assessors from concurrent membership on certain City boards and commissions. This change was requested by the City Council.

Mayor Lovett gave a brief explanation.

Mr. Hamilton said this is a fairly clean list of boards that may likely have a conflict with the Board of Assessors.

Mr. Morris said this was discussed at the last Council meeting.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Contois to adopt Ordinance 580 Board of Assessors Membership

Assistant Mayor Damren read the ordinance into the record.

Roll call vote:
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 8-0.

Sale of Property – Former Junior Sports League Building, 45 School Street

Mr. Morris said the Junior Sports League (JSL) Building was put out for bid and the City received one bid.

Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director, said that Jeff & Sarah Barrette are looking to grow their businesses and to add employees.

Mr. Morris said they may have to invest \$400,000 to complete the renovations of the building to meet ADA (Americans with Disabilities Act) standards, etc. This building has been vacant for

six years. This proposal will allow an existing business to expand. A site plan will be required, so this will go before the Planning Board.

Jeff Barrette said his businesses will fit very well in the JSL building. They have screen printing, food and vehicle/lettering businesses.

Ms. Merrill said the bid amount is \$5,000.

Mr. Barrette said he believes there is a higher and better use of his Water Street building. It would be a great gathering space of some sort. He said the JSL has recently been assessed at \$311,000, with a \$12,700 tax bill.

Councilors were happy that that the City would not have to continue to spend money to heat the empty building.

Mr. Barrette said assuming approval tonight, he has started applications for the Planning Board and the Zoning Board of Adjustment. If approved, he will close as soon as possible and he expects to start roof and heating repairs as soon as possible.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Kier to authorize the City Manager or his designees to negotiate, execute and undertake all such actions as may be required to convey City-owned land and improvements thereon, located at 45 School Street and identified as Tax Map 119-274, commonly referred to as the "Junior Sports League Building" to Jeff & Sarah Barrette for redevelopment of the building for the business purposes of Ink Factory Clothing Co./KG Signs and Awesome Sauce, LLC, its successors and assigns, as well as other site improvements, and to accept all proceeds related thereto for deposit into the applicable City account.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

Application for Community Revitalization Tax Relief Program (RSA 79-E) 31 Myrtle Street – Public Hearing

Mayor Lovett said this is a review of the application. No action is required tonight.

Ms. Merrill said this is the first RSA 79-E application in Claremont for a residential building. It is three units and is on 31 Myrtle Street. It is currently vacant and is under a lead order. The building is not located within the City's Historic District. It is a supporting structure to the Historic District. The applicants have applied for RSA 79-E for up to 5 years for the structure and up to 2 years for the historic building. This application meets the investment threshold. It also supports the Master Plan.

Jonathan Nelson, applicant, said he believes the building was designed by Albert Ball.

Mayor Lovett said this application is on the October 28 agenda as a resolution.

There was concern about expenditures meeting the required expenditure amount to qualify for 79-E. Mr. Nelson will put together updated numbers for the October 28th meeting.

Ordinance 581 Purchasing Policy – First Reading

The purpose of this proposed change is to increase the dollar limits applicable to the various levels of requirements for the City's purchasing regulations. The proposed change also separates out the intent and purpose provisions so that it clear that these provisions apply to the entire Division 12.

Enactment of this Ordinance will update the dollar limits throughout the purchasing procedures and will clarify the purpose and intent of the Purchasing Procedures Division of the Code. This change was requested by the City Council Policy and Finance Committees.

Assistant Mayor Damren said this will be a repeat from the last Council meeting. The Finance Committee was tasked with updating the Purchasing Policy. They worked with City Staff on it and then it was forwarded to the Policy Committee.

Councilor Stone said the Policy Committee found the updated numbers to be appropriate.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Koloski to suspend Council Rules to not have to read the ordinance.

Councilor Koloski thinks the previous vote tonight to suspend Council Rules should apply for the whole meeting.

Mayor Lovett said the ordinance needs to be read into the record at least one time.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Sweetser to adopt Ordinance 581 Purchasing Policy on first reading.

Assistant Mayor Damren read the Explanation of Proposed Action into the record.

Roll call vote:
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 8-0.

NHMA Funding for Councilors

Mayor Lovett said Councilor Contois would like to go to the NH Municipal Association Conference. She said she thought it was agreed in January that if an item was not more than \$250, it didn't need to come to Council for approval, however, it was done by consensus, but not by an actual vote.

Mr. Morris said at the January 8th meeting there was a discussion, but no follow-up.

Councilor Contois said the fee is \$65 for early registration and \$75 after that.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Matteau to authorize the expenditure of funds to allow Councilors to attend the 2020 NH Municipal Association Conference.

Roll call vote:
Kier - yes
Sweetser - yes
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - abstain
Stone - yes
Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-0, with 1 abstain.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Assistant Mayor Damren said the Finance Committee has met and discussed property tax credits. The next meeting will be Monday at 4 p.m. via Zoom.

Councilor Stone said the Policy Committee is wrapping up its discussion about the Holiday Display Policy tomorrow and it should be ready for the October 28th Council meeting.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski asked if the monitor in Central Collections, showing the solar panels output at the Wastewater Treatment Plan, can be moved to some other place in City Hall and turned on. Mr. Morris said when there is a power glitch, it shuts itself off. He will check with the IT office to see where it can be placed.

Councilor Koloski said the Councilors' email addresses on the City's website are not working. Mr. Morris said he will continue to work with the web developers on that.

Councilor Koloski asked to send out an eblast that if residents want to reach out to Councilors, they should use the specific email addresses and not the fill-in-the-box form that pops up.

Councilor Sweetser said she would like to know if Councilor Kier will be participating in the Policy Committee. Councilor Kier said she gave her reasons for not attending to deForest Bearse, Resource Coordinator. Councilor Sweetser said that Councilor Kier has not participated since August. Councilor Kier said she will be at the in-person meeting tomorrow.

Mayor Lovett said the Council has agreed to finalize the City Manager's evaluation on October 21st. It will be a non-public session for personnel starting at 6:30 p.m.

Mayor Lovett said the November 11th meeting falls on Veterans Day, so it has been moved to Thursday, November 12, in accordance with City Code. The second meeting of the month in November is the Wednesday before Thanksgiving. The proposal is not to have a second regularly scheduled meeting in November, however the compensation study is complete. It will need at least an hour to get through, so the proposal is to meet either November 4 or November 18. Mr. Morris said the study is not complete at this time, but it is close. There are some raises in the budget. He would like to get this scheduled. He expects the compensation plan presentation to be about 30 minutes, with questions and answers, it would probably be an hour. Mayor Lovett asked Councilors to check their calendars. She will send an email to Councilors through Ms. Russell for responses.

Mayor Lovett said for December, Council normally meets the second Wednesday of the month, but not the fourth Wednesday.

Mayor Lovett said the entire Council got a letter from Mr. Mooshian to change Columbus Day to Indigenous Peoples Day. There is an LSR (Legislative Service Request) in the system to change it at the state level. She recommended waiting to see if it goes through the state level by June 30th.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:18 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Sweetser to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council